

DET at CAR · Sunday 2026-10-04 20:20 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025. $n \geq 10$. No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: DET -3.5 / CAR +3.5, total 50.5. Trip: DET → CAR 501 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: DET 7 days, CAR 7 days. Roof: outdoors.

1. Season boxes

Wk	Team	Spot	Score	Line	ATS	Off yds	Rush	Pass EPA	Off EPA	Def EPA allowed	SR	TO
1	DET	H vs NO	31–30	–7.0	miss	371	165	+5.9	-2.1	+1.7	0.45	1
2	DET	A at BUF	31–41	+5.5	miss	393	66	+18.6	+18.3	+31.2	0.49	0
3	DET	H vs NYJ	31–24	–7.0	push	400	131	+12.1	+12.6	+7.1	0.60	0
1	CAR	H vs CHI	37–59	+3.0	miss	486	125	+15.1	+8.8	+27.0	0.47	3
2	CAR	A at ATL	34–3	–2.5	cover	355	68	+11.1	+2.3	-33.5	0.40	0
3	CAR	A at CLE	18–21	–2.5	miss	389	98	-5.9	-7.7	+0.2	0.37	1

Last game EPA (PBP): DET off +12.6, def allowed +7.1, net +5.5, SR 0.60. CAR off -7.7, def allowed +0.2, net -7.9, SR 0.37. Records: DET 2–1, CAR 1–2. ATS: DET 0–2, CAR 1–2.

2. Lookahead and rest

- DET: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 7). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs ARI, non-division, Sunday late window.
- CAR: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 3). 7 days rest. Week 5: bye.

3. Sides — CAR +3.5

CAR (home dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
home dog	168–169–8	49.9%	345
Sunday night home dog	10–8–1	55.6%	19
home dog +3.5 to +6.5	48–57	45.7%	105
Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5	10–11	47.6%	21

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off EPA ≤ -1 last, home dog	105–77–7	57.7%	189
off a loss as favorite, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	5–11	31.2%	16
off a loss as favorite, home dog	16–25–1	39.0%	42
equal rest, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	28–38	42.4%	66
scored ≤21 last, home dog	109–92–7	54.2%	208
off an ATS miss, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	22–30	42.3%	52
next game is road, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	34–43	44.2%	77
allowed ≤21 last, home dog	65–54–5	54.6%	124
allowed ≤21 last, Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5	4–7	36.4%	11
next game is road non-division, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	27–34	44.3%	61
off an ATS miss, Sunday night	34–27–4	55.7%	65
bye next week, Sunday night	13–9–1	59.1%	23
allowed ≤21 last, Sunday night	31–38	44.9%	69
off a road game, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	32–39	45.1%	71
bye next week, home dog	23–18	56.1%	41
success rate ≤ .40 last, home dog	71–62–3	53.4%	136
equal rest, home dog	111–100–5	52.6%	216
off a road game, Sunday night	38–32–4	54.3%	74

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
next game is road, home dog	126–115–7	52.3%	248
success rate $\leq .40$ last, Sunday night	16–20–3	44.4%	39
opponent off a win, home dog	105–96–4	52.2%	205
outdoors, Sunday night home dog	6–4–1	60.0%	11
bye next week, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	6–4	60.0%	10
off a loss, Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5	4–6	40.0%	10
off a loss, home dog +3.5 to +6.5	30–35	46.2%	65
off EPA ≤ -1 last, Sunday night	20–24–3	45.5%	47
next game is road, Sunday night	32–37–3	46.4%	72
off a loss, opponent off a win, Sunday night	16–13–2	55.2%	31

4. Sides — DET –3.5

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

DET (road favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road favorite	169–168–8	50.1%	345
Sunday night road favorite	8–10–1	44.4%	19
road fav –3.5 to –6.5	57–48	54.3%	105
Sunday night fav –3.5 to –6.5	11–10	52.4%	21

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road team from dome, outdoors, road favorite	46–30–1	60.5%	77
0 turnovers last, Sunday night	29–17–2	63.0%	48
next game is road, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	22–12	64.7%	34
scored ≥ 30 last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	24–14	63.2%	38
off a home game, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	41–28	59.4%	69
next game is road non-division, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	15–8	65.2%	23
success rate $\geq .50$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	13–7	65.0%	20
off a 1-score win, Sunday night	22–14–2	61.1%	38
off a 1-score win, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	19–12	61.3%	31
equal rest, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	38–28	57.6%	66
scored 27–33 last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	15–9	62.5%	24
scored ≥ 30 last, Sunday night	19–27–1	41.3%	47
0 turnovers last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	17–11	60.7%	28
opponent off an ATS miss, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	30–22	57.7%	52
off EPA $\geq +8$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	26–19	57.8%	45
0 turnovers last, road favorite	45–54–1	45.5%	100
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday night	27–34–4	44.3%	65
off a win as favorite, Sunday night	26–32–2	44.8%	60
equal rest, road favorite	100–111–5	47.4%	216
TO ≤ 1 last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	36–30	54.5%	66
next game is road non-division, road favorite	39–33–1	54.2%	73
off a home game, road favorite	117–107–5	52.2%	229
off a win, road favorite	96–105–4	47.8%	205
opponent off a loss, Sunday night fav –3.5 to –6.5	6–4	60.0%	10
outdoors, Sunday night road favorite	4–6–1	40.0%	11

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off EPA $\geq$ +8 last, Sunday night road favorite	4–6	40.0%	10
off a home game, Sunday night	29–34–2	46.0%	65
opponent off a loss, road fav –3.5 to –6.5	35–30	53.8%	65

5. Total 50.5

Cut	Over–Under	Over pct	n
Sunday night, outdoors, total $\geq$ 50	2–12	14.3%	14
Sunday night, total $\geq$ 50	4–15	21.1%	19
Sunday night, total $\geq$ 47	10–24	29.4%	34
Sunday night, outdoors, total $\geq$ 47	6–17	26.1%	23
outdoors, total $\geq$ 50	37–57–2	39.4%	96
Sunday night	26–43–1	37.7%	70
outdoors, home dog, total $\geq$ 50	12–24	33.3%	36
Sunday night, outdoors	19–32–1	37.3%	52
home dog, total $\geq$ 50	23–33–2	41.1%	58
Sunday night, home dog	12–7	63.2%	19
outdoors, home dog	122–138–2	46.9%	262
outdoors, total $\geq$ 47	109–124–3	46.8%	236
total $\geq$ 50	71–82–4	46.4%	157
total $\geq$ 47	167–179–5	48.3%	351
outdoors, home dog, total $\geq$ 47	42–46	47.7%	88
home dog	167–174–4	49.0%	345
outdoors	343–350–7	49.5%	700
home dog, total $\geq$ 47	61–63–2	49.2%	126

6. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: no
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: applies to CAR
- off a bye: no
- scored $\leq$ 10 last: no
- short week: no
- trip $\geq$ 1000 mi: no
- TO $\geq$ 3 last: no
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

7. Stack, without double-counting

Stack floor is $n \geq 20$ (tables use $n \geq 10$). Traits are added by largest parent-minus-child gap (the stack's pct against the pct of the games the trait removes), not by a fixed order. Read the hold-out first; the builder has no out-of-sample edge as a class (nine stacks picked at $\geq 60\%$ on 2015–20 went 81–15 then 40–39). Under each stack: hold-out, by-season W-L, cover-margin quartiles with signed tails, parent-minus-child (the stack without each trait, and the games that trait removed), the anchor's complement, the stack split by line bucket, a contrary cross (the team's own traits that run against it on the anchor, crossed into the stack), and a hold-out (traits chosen on 2015–20 only at a scaled floor of $n \geq 10$, printed on 2021–25).

- **CAR +3.5** — one population: Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5. ATS 10–11 (47.6%, $n=21$). Not added (no gap with $n \geq 20$ left): equal rest, off a loss, off a 1-score loss, off an ATS miss, off a loss as favorite, off a road game, scored ≤ 21 last, allowed ≤ 21 last....
- **Hold-out** (traits chosen on 2015–20 only at $n \geq 10$: Sunday night home dog): 2015–20 6–5–1 (54.5%, $n=12$) → 2021–25 4–3 (57.1%, $n=7$)
- By season: 16:0-1 17:0-1 18:3-3 19:1-1 20:2-0 21:4-0 22:0-1 23:0-1 24:0-3

- Cover margin: median -0.5, q25/q75 -2.5/+5.5; P(>+7) 0.14, P(<-7) 0.19
- Anchor alone 10–11 (47.6%, n=21); anchor minus stack 0–0 (—, n=0)
- Stack by line bucket: +3.5 to +6.5 10–11 (47.6%, n=21)
- Contrary cross (team's own traits that run against it on this anchor, then crossed into the stack): allowed ≤21 last: 4–7 (36.4%, n=11) → in stack 4–7 (36.4%, n=11) | off a loss: 4–6 (40.0%, n=10) → in stack 4–6 (40.0%, n=10) | outdoors: 7–9 (43.8%, n=16) → in stack 7–9 (43.8%, n=16) | TO ≤1 last: 5–6 (45.5%, n=11) → in stack 5–6 (45.5%, n=11)
- **DET -3.5** — one population: Sunday night fav -3.5 to -6.5. ATS 11–10 (52.4%, n=21). Not added (no gap with n ≥ 20 left): equal rest, trip 200–1000 mi, 0 time zones, off a win, off a 1-score win, off a win as favorite, off a home game, scored 27–33 last....
- **Hold-out** (traits chosen on 2015–20 only at n ≥ 10: Sunday night road favorite): 2015–20 5–6–1 (45.5%, n=12) → 2021–25 3–4 (42.9%, n=7)
- By season: 16:1-0 17:1-0 18:3-3 19:1-1 20:0-2 21:0-4 22:1-0 23:1-0 24:3-0
- Cover margin: median +0.5, q25/q75 -5.5/+2.5; P(>+7) 0.19, P(<-7) 0.14
- Anchor alone 11–10 (52.4%, n=21); anchor minus stack 0–0 (—, n=0)
- Stack by line bucket: -3.5 to -6.5 11–10 (52.4%, n=21)
- Contrary cross (team's own traits that run against it on this anchor, then crossed into the stack): off a win: 6–7 (46.2%, n=13) → in stack 6–7 (46.2%, n=13) | off yards ≥400 last: 6–7 (46.2%, n=13) → in stack 6–7 (46.2%, n=13)
- **Total 50.5, tightest cut clearing n = 20:** Sunday night, total ≥47 — O–U 10–24 (29.4%, n=34).
- By season (O–U): 15:1-1 16:2-1 17:0-2 18:1-4 19:1-3 20:1-3 21:1-3 22:0-2 23:0-2 24:1-1 25:2-2
- Total margin (points – line): median -4.2, q25/q75 -11.0/+1.4; P(>+7) 0.15, P(<-7) 0.44
- **Hold-out** (cut chosen on 2015–20 only at n ≥ 10: Sunday night, outdoors, total ≥50): 2015–20 1–9 (10.0%, n=10) → 2021–25 1–3 (25.0%, n=4)
- By total band: 45–49 6–9 (n=15); ≥50 4–15 (n=19)

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats_team_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play_by_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).